

Southwark Land Partnership

Terms of Reference

Background

The Southwark Land Commission was established to explore how more land in the borough could be used for further benefit to the local community. The Southwark Land Partnership Group (SLPG) will be convened in direct response to the recommendations of the 2023 Southwark Land Commission report, *Land for Good*. The Commission called for a fundamental shift in how land is used, governed, and shared in the borough – placing social purpose and transparency at the heart of land use decisions. Recommendation 6 – Give the community real power and voice, recommends “*bringing together participating landowners into a Southwark Land Partnership, committed to freeing up land for the public good through the Social Purpose of Land Framework.*”

The SLPG will be established to bring together key landowners involved in land use, development, and stewardship across the London Borough of Southwark. The borough faces unique challenges and opportunities related to housing, regeneration, green space, heritage, and community development. The SLPG aims to ensure that land use decisions are inclusive, sustainable, and aligned with Southwark Council's strategic priorities.

It was agreed on 22 July 2024 that the Terms of Reference and membership of the SLPG be delegated to the Cabinet Member for New Homes and Sustainable Development.

Purpose

The SLPG is a key mechanism to help implement the Land Commission recommendations, particularly:

- Recommendation 1: Put social purpose at the heart of land use
- Recommendation 2: Map what's there and what isn't
- Recommendation 3: Take control of our land and assets

- Recommendation 6: Give the community real power and voice

The SLPG serves as a collaborative forum to:

- Foster collaboration between Southwark Council communities, landowners, private sector and other stakeholders
- Support the delivery of Southwark 2030, housing targets, and climate action goals.
- Support the implementation of the Land Commission's recommendations.
- Empower communities to shape land use decisions.
- Promote coordinated and transparent land use planning and development.
- Facilitate dialogue between public and private sector stakeholders.
- Identify and address land-related challenges, including affordability, access, and environmental impact.

Objectives

- Share data, insights, and best practices on land use and development in Southwark.
- Provide input into planning policy, regeneration projects, and land-based initiatives.
- Encourage inclusive development that reflects the needs of Southwark's diverse communities.
- Monitor and report on progress in implementing the Social Purpose of Land Framework.

Membership

Membership will include representatives from:

Categories	Stakeholders
Southwark Council	Council Chief Executive Senior representatives from Planning, Sustainable Growth, Housing, Environment, Property, and Local Economy Cllr Sarah King (Chair) Cllr Helen Dennis
Government Authorities	Greater London Authority (GLA), Transport for London (TfL), London Fire Brigade, London Mayor's Office for Policing and Crime, NHS Integrated Care Boards

Local landowners and developers	BIDs, British Land, Land Securities, Berkeley, Barratts, Arch Co, Network Rail, Dulwich Estate, Kings Hospital, Guys and St Thomas, SLAM, Dorrington, LSBU, Greystar, Delancey, Get Living, Native Land, Inter Faith Forum
Registered housing providers	Peabody, L&Q
Existing Regeneration Partnerships	Chair of Elephant and Castle Partnership Chair of London Bridge Partnership

Membership will be reviewed annually to ensure broad and balanced representation.

The following criteria outlines how membership has been determined:

Strategic Influence and Land Ownership

Members must hold or manage land that significantly impacts Southwark's urban fabric – whether through housing, infrastructure, public services or community assets.

Members must have ownership, stewardship or development rights over land that is:

- Publicly accessible (whether part of full)
- Strategically located within the borough
- Using land in ways that promote social, environmental and economic benefit

A balanced forum requires voices from public, housing, private and faith-based sectors. Members must represent one or more of the following:

- Local government departments with land-related responsibilities
- Public authorities (e.g. NHS, TfL, GLA)
- Major developers and institutional landowners
- Registered housing providers
- Faith and community land stewards
- Regeneration partnerships

Roles and Responsibilities

- Chair (Southwark Council representative): Convene and facilitate meetings, set agendas, and ensure alignment with borough priorities.
- Members: Actively participate in meetings, share relevant information, and contribute to working groups or task forces as needed.

- Secretariat (provided by Southwark Council): Coordinate logistics, circulate agendas and minutes, and maintain records.

Refer to **Attachment 1** for a template agenda.

Meetings

Frequency	Bi-annually, with additional meetings and working groups as required.
Format	Hybrid (in-person and virtual options).
Quorum	At least 50% of member organisations represented.
Decision-making	Consensus where possible; otherwise, by majority vote.

Reporting and Communication

- Meeting summaries and key decisions will be shared with all members.
- An annual progress report will be produced, tracking implementation of the Land Commission's recommendations and the group's contributions.
- Minutes will be made publicly available on Council's website.

Review and Amendments

- The ToR will be reviewed annually by the group.
- Amendments must be approved by a majority of members present at the relevant meeting changes are discussed.

Duration

The SLPG will operate on an ongoing basis, subject to annual review and continued relevance to Southwark's strategic land use objectives and progress on the Land Commission's implementation roadmap.

Documents that can be tabled

The following documents are deemed appropriate to be tabled at this meeting:

- Implementation roadmap or planning documents – e.g. timeline and milestones for each recommendation, assigned leads and responsible teams
- Mapping – e.g. visuals or screenshots of the open-access land map, data sources and methodology
- Social Purpose of Land Framework – e.g. principles or methodology for land use aligned with community benefit, framework documentation, consultation feedback summary
- Pilot Site Briefs – e.g. site descriptions, ownership, and proposed uses, pipeline of developments and existing or proposed workspace hubs
- Community/stakeholder engagement plans
- Budget, and governance documentation and potential funding sources,
- Biodiversity corridor proposals
- Risk register – e.g. key risks to implementation and mitigation strategies
- Monitoring and Evaluation – e.g. KPIs and success metrics, reporting schedules (including social value reporting)

Attachment 1 – Template Agenda

Date & Time	TBC 9:30am – 11:30am
Location	-
Attendees	-
Chair	-
Apologies	-

Agenda Item	Presenter	Duration
Welcome and Introductions	Chair	5 mins
Progress Updates on Priority Actions Social Purpose of Land Framework	Chair	40 mins
Strategic Planning and Next Steps - Timeline for implementation of key actions - Roles and responsibilities - Funding and resource allocation - Monitoring and evaluation framework	Chair/TBC	25 mins
Community Engagement Strategy - Outreach plans - Inclusion and accessibility - Feedback mechanisms	Chair/TBC	20 mins
Round the Grounds Attendees provide an update on key projects or initiatives relevant for the group and Land Commission Report	All attendees	20 mins
AOB	All attendees	10 mins